

Special Notice (SN) DARPA-SN-26-49: Fleetwood Industry Day

DATE: March 12th, 2026

LOCATION: SPA Research Collaboration Center, 4075 Wilson Blvd., Suite 201, Arlington, VA 22203

REGISTRATION DEADLINE:

March 4th, 2026, 5:00 PM ET for foreign nationals, March 6th, 2026, 5:00PM for U.S. citizens, or when capacity is reached, whichever comes first.

REGISTRATION WEBSITE: <https://events.sa-meetings.com/FleetwoodIndustryDay>

TECHNICAL POC: Dr. William Mounfield, DARPA/BTO

Email: Fleetwood@darpa.mil

The Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA) will host an in-person Industry Day with a virtual listening option in support of the DARPA Program Solicitation (PS) for Fleetwood on March 12, 2026. DARPA anticipates releasing the program solicitation prior to Industry Day. If released, the PS will be made available at <https://sam.gov/>.

The goals of the Industry Day are:

- 1) To introduce the science and technology community (industry, academia, and government) to the Fleetwood program vision and goals;
- 2) To facilitate interaction between researchers with capabilities and interests relevant to the Fleetwood program goals;
- 3) To collect questions during the event that DARPA may answer and make available in a Question and Answer document; and
- 4) To encourage and promote teaming arrangements among organizations that have the relevant expertise, research facilities, and capabilities to execute research and development aligned with the Fleetwood program goals.

The Industry Day will include overview presentations by government personnel and opportunities for team building among the participants. It is anticipated that Industry Day materials will be posted online to <https://www.darpa.mil/research/programs/fleetwood>.

Program Objective and Description:

The Biological Technology Office (BTO) leverages biological processes, technologies, and manufacturing opportunities to create resilient infrastructures and supply chains, protective solutions, and innovative sensors to ensure mission success in any location. To that end, the Fleetwood program aims to develop stable, active, and selective catalysts that are capable of upgrading lignin-containing waste biomass feedstocks, both domestically and in deployed environments, thereby accessing a robust source for value-added products and precursors.

Current supply chain logistics rely on complex production systems and transportation networks to provide petroleum-derived chemicals for commercial and military applications. Increasingly,

manufacturers depend on foreign-sourced imports to produce finished products, posing significant economic and strategic risks to U.S. supply chains. The conversion of waste streams, such as municipal, agricultural, and logging waste, has been explored as a potential route to produce molecules that can augment supplies of traditional petrochemicals. Industry struggles to utilize abundant lignocellulosic feedstocks and produce high-value products as lignocellulosic feedstocks are notoriously difficult to process and refine. Lignin, a key component, is nature's largest repository of aromatic compounds but is often treated as a waste product. Current conversion methods like gasification, pyrolysis, and hydrothermal liquefaction suffer from low yields, poor selectivity, and high energy requirements, limiting their economic viability. The Fleetwood program seeks to overcome these limitations by developing transformative catalytic technologies to unlock the value of lignin.

The program objective is accomplished through two Focus Areas (FAs). The first focuses on developing approaches to extract lignin from a variety of feedstocks, and the second focuses on ensuring catalyst stability while maximizing activity and selectivity to convert lignin into chemicals traditionally derived or sourced from imports. Pyrolysis, gasification, and hydrothermal liquefaction approaches are excluded and considered out of scope. Teaming is highly encouraged to ensure the expertise and capabilities necessary to meet Fleetwood's goals.

Registration Information:

Registrations will be cut off at the registration deadline listed above. Any change to the registration deadline will be communicated through an amendment to this notice and an update to the registration website.

The Industry Day is open only to registered potential proposers. The event is not open to the general public and media. An online registration form, preliminary agenda, foreign national visit request form, and meeting details are available on the registration website.

Additionally, all meeting registrants who are not U.S. Citizens must complete and submit the following:

U.S. Permanent Residents and Foreign Nationals not representing a foreign government are required to submit a DARPA Form 60, titled "U.S. Permanent Resident and Foreign National Visit Request," The form can be submitted via the following link: <https://dtsn.darpa.mil/eform60/>. All forms must be submitted no later than **March 4, 2026, at 5:00 PM ET. NOTE: This is in advance of the registration deadline.** Failure to complete and submit the required forms by the specified deadline may result in the cancellation of existing registration.

Opportunities for Teaming:

While not required, DARPA encourages teaming amongst the community when appropriate and strategic to achieving program outcomes. To support team building, Industry Day registrants may opt to participate in the following:

- 1) **Attendee List:** Participant contact information (name, organization, email address) will be automatically included on a Fleetwood Industry Day attendee list, which will be shared with other prospective proposers unless otherwise specified. Registrants may indicate during registration whether they opt in or out. The attendee list will be sent to all event registrants.
- 2) **Teaming Profiles:** Interested parties are also invited to submit a one- to two-page ‘teaming profile’ describing technical competencies, unique facilities and other capabilities, as they relate to the program, and desired technical/other competencies sought from other potential team partners. The profile should conform to the template provided with this notice and on the registration website; if choosing to submit, the profile is due by **March 10, 2026 at 5:00PM ET to Fleetwood@darpa.mil**. Further details will be provided on the registration website, but teaming profiles should include, at a minimum:
 - Contact information, to include name, organization, email, telephone number, mailing address, and website;
 - Brief description of the proposer’s technical competencies and relevant facilities;
 - Desired technical competencies and facilities from other potential team members, if applicable.

Profiles that do not use the provided word template (Attachment 2) and/or exceed the two-page limit will not be accepted. Information contained in teaming profiles shall be publicly releasable – profile submitters consent to distribution amongst event registrants. After Industry Day, the teaming profiles will be sent via email to all registrants. Specific content, communications, networking, and team formation are the sole responsibility of participants. Neither DARPA nor the DoW endorses any participating organization, nor does DARPA or DoW exercise any responsibility for improper dissemination of the teaming profiles.

- 3) **Lightning Round:** A lightning round will be held to facilitate interaction among attendees, providing an opportunity to showcase capabilities and build strong teams to address the challenges presented in Fleetwood. A presentation template will be provided to those who are presenting during the lightning round. Presentations should highlight proposer capabilities, teaming requirements, and must include presenter’s contact information. Each organization is limited to one slide, and presentations will be restricted to five minutes each. Registrants must indicate their intent to participate in the lightning round session during registration. Due to time constraints, the number of lightning round presentations will be limited. Lightning round presenters must attend in-person. Portions of the Industry Day are expected to be recorded and made available online on the DARPA website following the conclusion of the event.

All presentations must be submitted in PowerPoint format with a PDF backup. Unclassified presentations should be emailed to Fleetwood@darpa.mil no later than **March 10, 2026, at 5:00 PM ET**. Presentations must not contain any Controlled Unclassified Information

(CUI), export-controlled information, or classified information and must be suitable for unlimited public release. NO CLASSIFIED INFORMATION SHOULD BE SENT.

DARPAConnect:

Entities who have not worked with DARPA before are encouraged to learn more about DARPAConnect, an initiative established to facilitate collaboration between DARPA and potential performers. The DARPAConnect team offers customized support, resources, and guidance on how to prepare ideas for high-impact conversations with DARPA program managers. Please visit [DARPAConnect.us](https://darpaconnect.us) to access a digital hub of online resources, including a curriculum for self-paced learning, personalized support, and in-person and virtual events. To prepare for the Industry Day, attendees can leverage the learning module on “Making the Most of a DARPA Proposers Day.” In addition to the self-paced online materials, the DARPAConnect team is able to schedule one-on-one conversations to discuss specific ideas, questions, and paths to DARPA. Use the contact form at [DARPAConnect.us](https://darpaconnect.us) or email the DARPAConnect team directly at darpaconnect@darpa.mil to request assistance.

Administrative:

All administrative and technical questions should be directed to Fleetwood@darpa.mil. Please refer to the Special Notice number (DARPA-SN-26-49) in all correspondence.

This SN is issued solely for information and potential new program planning purposes; the SN does not constitute a formal solicitation for proposals or proposal abstracts. In accordance with FAR 15.201(e), responses to this notice are not offers and cannot be accepted by the Government to form a binding contract. Submission is voluntary and is not required to propose to subsequent Broad Agency Announcements (if any) or research solicitations (if any) on this topic. DARPA will not provide reimbursement for costs incurred in responding to this SN. Respondents are advised that DARPA is under no obligation to acknowledge receipt of the information received or provide feedback to respondents with respect to any information submitted under this SN.

NO CLASSIFIED INFORMATION SHOULD BE INCLUDED IN THE SN RESPONSE.